

Wisecracks aside, the best way to start “growing your network” is to click the Communities link.

9.3.2 Communities

Under the Communities link, you’ll see a category-wise listing. Choosing a relevant category will reveal the communities under it. And clicking on a community name takes you to the Community page. The Community page, among other things, reveals the Members, a forum, and an Events Calendar.

In Orkut, a Community stands for a common meeting ground for people sharing the interest as signified by the Community name or its description. It is the basic social network unit. Anyone can create a Community. What counts is the number of people who become members. Say you are a Linux fan looking for others sharing your passion. Becoming a member of the Linux and Free Software communities exposes you to other people who share your tastes. Knowing that you share similar interests improves your chances of finding someone you feel comfortable with. This way, you’re already on your way to forming an acquaintance.

It needs to be mentioned that one need not become a member of a Community to know its members and befriend them. But, since that is the way you came to know of them, it pays to be a member of the Community, even though you are not in any other way contributing to it.



Community listing